

MCA Manager — Admin Onboarding Guide

Your guide to getting started as an admin · May Creative Arts · August 2026

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1. Welcome

What MCA Manager is, and what your part in it looks like.

MCA Manager is May Creative Arts' practice management app. It's where therapy sessions get logged, clients get managed, invoices get created and sent, and contractors get tracked — all in one place, on your computer or your phone.

As an **admin**, you're the hub of the daily workflow. Contractors log their sessions; you review and approve them; the app turns approved work into invoices; you send those invoices and record payments. This guide walks you through each of those pieces in the order you'll meet them.

How to use this guide: read sections 1–4 before your first day if you can — they cover everything you'll touch in a normal day. Sections 5–8 are there when you need them. Section 11 is a one-page cheat sheet worth printing.

The app teaches too. MCA Manager has built-in interactive walkthroughs that highlight each button on the real screens as you click through. This guide tells you which ones to take and when — see [Section 9](#).

2. Day One Checklist

Six steps, about 20 minutes, and you're fully set up.

1 Accept your invite.

You'll receive an email invitation to join May Creative Arts on MCA Manager. Click the link and create your account with a strong password. The app lives at

`https://maycreativearts.vercel.app` — bookmark it.

2 Log in and look around.

After logging in you land on the Dashboard. Nothing you click while browsing will send anything to a client — invoices only go out when you explicitly send them.

3 Set up two-factor authentication (if prompted).

Because the app holds client health information, your account may require an authenticator app (Google Authenticator, Authy, etc.). Follow the prompt, or set it up any time under **Settings > Profile & Security**.

4 Install the app on your phone.

There's no app store download — you install it straight from the browser. On **iPhone**: open the site in Safari → Share button → **Add to Home Screen**. On **Android**: open it in Chrome → tap the **Install** banner (or menu → Add to Home Screen). On **desktop**: look for the install icon in Chrome/Edge's address bar.

5 Take the "App Overview" walkthrough.

Open **Help** from the sidebar and start the **App Overview** walkthrough. It points out each area of the app on the live screens — the fastest way to get oriented.

6 Meet the AI helper.

The round sparkle button in the bottom-right corner answers questions in plain English — "how do scholarship invoices work?", "what's our no-show fee?". One rule: never type client names or health details into it (it doesn't need them and can't see client data anyway).

3. Finding Your Way Around

The Dashboard is your morning coffee screen — it surfaces everything that needs you.

The Dashboard

The stats across the top give you the pulse: sessions this month, total clients, recently approved sessions, and pending invoices with the dollars outstanding. Below that, the **Action Center** lists what actually needs doing, most urgent first — overdue invoices, sessions waiting for approval, unsent invoices, unbilled scholarship sessions. Each card has a jump-in link, and cards only appear when there's something to act on. An empty Action Center means you're caught up.

MCA Manager

Developer

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View As

LW

Dashboard

Sessions

Clients

Billing

Analytics

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Settings

Dashboard

Welcome back! Here's an overview of your practice.

New Session

Sessions This Month

0

Total Clients

42

Recently Approved

7

last 30 days

Pending Invoices

115

\$12,440.00 outstanding

Monthly Revenue

\$380.00

Monthly Revenue

MCA Earnings

\$105.00

Sessions

0

Full Analytics

Pending Approvals

20 sessions awaiting approval

View All

Select all

Adaptive Lesson

Jun 11 · 30 min · Lucas Weber

Test User

Approve

Revise

Music Expressions Group

Feb 26 · 45 min · Colleen Mitholland

People Inc Day Hab

Approve

Revise

Musical Expressions

Feb 26 · 30 min · Megan Brunner

Molly Hathaway (People Inc SD)

Approve

Revise

Musical Expressions

Unsent Invoices

20 invoices pending · \$2,000.00 total

View All

Help

The sidebar — your map

MENU ITEM	WHAT IT'S FOR
Dashboard	Today's overview and the Action Center.
Sessions	Every logged session — review, approve, filter, search. Your most-visited page.
Clients	The client list: contact info, payment setup, session history, portal invites.
Billing > Invoices	All invoices — pending, sent, paid, overdue — plus the Scholarship tab for monthly batches.
Team	Who's on the team, and where you invite new contractors or admins.
Settings	For you, mostly Profile & Security (password, two-factor). Organization-wide settings are managed by the owner.
Help	The Help Center: searchable articles, FAQs, interactive walkthroughs, and the AI helper.

If you've seen screenshots with **Payroll** or **Analytics** menu items and don't have them — that's normal. Those are owner-only (see [Section 10](#)).

4. Sessions — Your Daily Core

Sessions are the heartbeat of the app. Everything else — invoices, pay, reports — flows from them.

How a session moves through the app



A contractor logs a session and **submits** it. Submitting is the moment the money side starts: the app immediately creates a **pending invoice** for each attending client (scholarship and monthly-billed clients are the exception — their sessions accumulate for a monthly batch instead). The session then waits in your review queue until you **approve** it.

Two side paths: a session can be marked **No-Show** (client didn't attend — a flat no-show fee is charged, and the contractor still gets their normal session pay) or **Cancelled** (removed from billing entirely — no invoice).

The Sessions page

Each card shows the date, service type, client, contractor, duration, and a status badge. Use the search bar (client, contractor, or service name) and the filters (status, date range, contractor) to find anything. Sessions with a **Submitted** badge are waiting on you.

MCA Manager

Dashboard

Sessions

Clients

Billing

Analytics

Team

Settings

Help

DeveloperMay Creative ArtsView As

SessionsView and manage all sessions

ListCalendarExport SessionsNew Session

Search by service, client, or contractor...Date (Newest)Filters

All Sessions127 sessions total (showing 50)

Select all submitted (43)

Adaptive LessonSubmittedThu, Jun 11 · 30 min · 1 attendee · Lucas Weber
Test User

ApproveRevise

Musical ExpressionsApprovedTue, Jun 9 · 30 min · 1 attendee · Amara May Bentley

Adaptive LessonApprovedFri, Feb 27 · 30 min · 1 attendee · Miley Heisler
Claire (Tina Syracuse)

Musical ExpressionsApprovedFri, Feb 27 · 45 min · 1 attendee · Jacob Nicholson
Zack Dawson (People Inc SD)

Musical ExpressionsApprovedFri, Feb 27 · 30 min · 1 attendee · Miley Heisler
Alex S

Musical ExpressionsApprovedFri, Feb 27 · 30 min · 1 attendee · Miley Heisler
Claire (Tina Syracuse)

Musical ExpressionsApprovedThu, Feb 26 · 30 min · 1 attendee · Miley Heisler
Kemet (Sarah Mulhollen)

Music Expressions Group ApprovedThu, Feb 26 · 45 min · 17 attendees · Miley Heisler
People Inc Day Hab

Reviewing and approving

Submitted sessions show **Approve** and **Revise** buttons right on the card. Before approving, give it a quick sanity check: right client, right service type, right duration, notes present if required. Then:

- **Approve** — confirms the session. Its invoice already exists (created at submission) and is now ready to send whenever you're ready.
- **Revise** — sends it back to the contractor with a note explaining what to fix. The pending invoice is removed automatically, and recreated when they resubmit — nothing goes unbilled and nothing gets double-billed.
- **Mark No-Show / Cancel / Delete** — available from the session's detail page.

Bulk approve: when several sessions are ready at once (say, end of the week), use the checkboxes — or "Select all submitted" — and hit **Approve (N)** in the bar that appears. It runs the same checks as approving one at a time.

The screenshot displays the MCA Manager interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: Dashboard, Sessions (highlighted), Clients, Billing, Analytics, Team, and Settings. The main content area is titled 'Sessions > Adaptive Lesson' and shows a session card for 'Adaptive Lesson' on Thursday, June 11, 2026. The card is in a 'Submitted' state, indicated by a blue button. Above the session details are buttons for 'Approve Session' (blue), 'Request Revision' (yellow), 'No Show' (orange), 'Cancel' (red), 'Edit' (pencil icon), and 'Delete' (trash icon). The session details are organized into three main sections: 'Session Information' (Date & Time: Thursday, June 11, 2026 at 9:00 AM; Duration: 30 minutes; Contractor: Lucas Weber, weberlucasdev@gmail.com; Service Type: Adaptive Lesson, Base: \$45.00), 'Billing Summary' (Attendees: 1 client; Total Amount: \$45.00; Contractor Pay: \$45.00; MCA Cut: \$0.00), and 'Attendees' (Test User, weberlucasdev@gmail.com, \$45.00). Below these is a 'Session Notes' section with 'Internal Notes' (asdfasdf) and 'Client Notes' (adsfasdf). At the bottom, it shows 'Created: 6/11/2026, 10:06:09 AM' and 'Last updated: 7/4/2026, 2:15:51 PM'. A 'Help' link is in the bottom left corner.

MCA Manager | Developer | May Creative Arts | View As | LW

Sessions > Adaptive Lesson

Adaptive Lesson | Submitted | Approve Session | Request Revision | No Show | Cancel | Edit | Delete

Thursday, June 11, 2026

Session Information
Details about this session

Date & Time
Thursday, June 11, 2026 at 9:00 AM

Duration
30 minutes

Contractor
Lucas Weber
weberlucasdev@gmail.com

Service Type
Adaptive Lesson
Base: \$45.00

Billing Summary
Financial breakdown for this session

Attendees
1 client

Total Amount
\$45.00

Contractor Pay
\$45.00

MCA Cut
\$0.00

Attendees
Clients who attended this session

Test User
weberlucasdev@gmail.com | \$45.00

Session Notes

Internal Notes
asdfasdf

Client Notes
adsfasdf

Created: 6/11/2026, 10:06:09 AM
Last updated: 7/4/2026, 2:15:51 PM

Help

Logging a session yourself

Mostly contractors log their own sessions, but you can log one for anyone. Click **New Session** on the Sessions page (on mobile, the floating + button). The form asks for date and time, duration, service type, client(s), and notes. The service type drives all the pricing automatically — you never calculate anything by hand.

Two kinds of notes, and the difference matters: **Internal Notes** are visible only to staff. **Client Notes** appear in the client's portal. Both are encrypted for HIPAA compliance.

The screenshot shows the 'Log New Session' form in the MCA Manager interface. The left sidebar contains navigation links: Dashboard, Sessions (highlighted), Clients, Billing, Analytics, Team, and Settings. The top header shows 'MCA Manager', a 'Developer' role indicator, a 'May Creative Arts' dropdown, a 'View As' dropdown, and a user profile 'LW'. The main form area is titled 'Log New Session' with a subtitle 'Record a therapy session. All fields marked with * are required.' The form includes the following sections:

- Session Details:**
 - Date ***: 07/06/2026 (with a calendar icon)
 - Time ***: 09:00 AM (with a clock icon)
 - Duration (minutes) ***: 30 minutes (dropdown menu)
 - Service Type ***: Musical Expressions (dropdown menu)
 - Rate**: \$60
 - Clients ***: Test User (with a search icon and 'X' to remove)
- Pricing Breakdown:**

Total Amount:	\$60.00
Per Person:	\$60.00
MCA Cut:	\$0.00
Contractor Pay:	\$60.00
- Internal Notes ***: A text area for notes visible only to staff.
- Client Notes ***: A text area for notes visible to the client in their portal.
- Save as:** Radio buttons for 'Submit for approval' (selected) and 'Save as draft'.
- Buttons:** 'Cancel' and 'Submit Session'.
- Footer:** 'Reset remembered defaults'.

Tip: the form remembers your last-used time, duration, and service type, and a **Log Another** button appears after each submission — logging a full day of sessions takes a couple of minutes.

5. Clients

Every client's contact info, billing setup, and history in one place.

The client list

The Clients page shows everyone with their contact info and payment method. The stats at the top flag clients missing contact details. Click any row to open the client's full record: session history, invoices, goals, and shared resources.

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Clients

Manage your client list and contact information

Add Client

Total Clients

42

Missing Contact Info

5

Search by name, email, or phone...

All Methods

42 of 42 clients

Name	Contact	Payment Method	Billing	Notes	Actions
Aden Finkas (People Inc SC)	css_department@people-inc.org	Self-Directed	Square	People Inc SC	
Alex S	tbrege@opschools.org	Private Pay	Square	-	
Anthony (Trina)	Turner6987@gmail.com	Private Pay	Square	-	
Bentley	No contact info	Scholarship	Square	-	
Brayden Davis (People Inc SD)	css_department@people-inc.org	Self-Directed	Square	People Inc SD	
Brendan (Alicia Dejesus)	alicia.dejesus@people-inc.org	Group Home	Square	People Inc	
Bryan (Erica Palmer)	epalmer316@msn.com	Private Pay	Square	-	
BryLin (Shannon Fagan)	sfagan@brylin.com	Group Home	Square	BryLin	
Claire (Tina Syracuse)	tina@briansbestgf.com	Private Pay	Square	-	
Courtney Jordan	michaela.chatmon@people-inc.org	Private Pay	Square	-	
Dan (Toni Gordon)	toni.gordon@people-inc.org	Group Home	Square	People Inc	
Devon	No contact info	Scholarship	Square	-	
Elijah (Courtney Siever)	courtney.siever@yahoo.com	Private Pay	Square	-	
Ethan (Tricia Dellapenta)	css_department@people-inc.org	Self-Directed	Square	People Inc SD	
Faith Jaromin (People Inc SD)	css_department@people-inc.org	Self-Directed	Square	People Inc SD	

Adding a client — the two settings that matter

Click **Add Client**, enter their name and contact info, and set two fields that drive everything billing-related later:

	QUESTION IT ANSWERS	OPTIONS
Payment Method	<i>Who pays, and how is the session classified?</i> Determines how much is billed — scholarship clients get the flat scholarship rate and monthly batching.	Private Pay · Self-Directed · Group Home · Scholarship · Venmo
Billing Method	<i>How does their invoice get delivered?</i> Determines whether you send a Square payment link, an emailed PDF, or track a check by hand.	Square · Email · Check · Other

The screenshot shows the MCA Manager interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: Dashboard, Sessions, Clients (selected), Billing, Analytics, Team, and Settings. The main area is titled 'Clients' with a subtitle 'Manage your client list and contact information'. It shows a list of 42 clients. An 'Add New Client' modal is open in the center, containing the following fields and options:

- Name ***: Text input with placeholder 'Client name'.
- Email**: Text input with placeholder 'client@example.com'.
- Phone**: Text input with placeholder '(555) 123-4567'.
- Payment Method**: Dropdown menu with 'Private Pay' selected.
- Billing Method**: Dropdown menu with 'Square' selected.
- Invoicing**: Dropdown menu with 'Per session (invoice on approval)' selected.
- Add Square processing fee to invoices**: A checkbox with a note: 'Applies the fee configured in Settings > Business Rules > Invoices when this client's invoices are sent via Square. You can remove it from an individual invoice before sending.'
- Notes**: Text area with placeholder 'Any additional notes about this client...'.
- Buttons**: 'Cancel' and 'Add Client'.

The background shows a table of existing clients with columns for Name, Payment Method, Billing, Notes, and Actions. The table lists 42 clients, including Aden Finkas, Alex S, Anthony (Trina), Bentley, Brayden Davis, Brendan (Alicia Dejesus), Bryan (Erica Palmer), BryLin (Shannon Fagan), Claire (Tina Syracuse), Courtney Jordan, Dan (Toni Gordon), Devon, Elijah (Courtney Siever), Ethan (Tricia Dellapenta), and Faith Jaromin.

Worth double-checking: a client's payment method is the single most consequential setting in the app — it decides whether they're invoiced per-session or batched monthly. If a new client's billing looks wrong later, this is the first place to look.

The client portal invite

From a client's page you can send a **portal invite** — a secure link where the client (or their family) sees their session history, notes you've shared, goals, and resources. More in [Section 8](#).

6. Invoices

The app writes the invoices; you decide when they go out.

Where invoices come from

You almost never create an invoice by hand. When a session is submitted, the app generates one pending invoice per attending client, priced from the service type. Pending invoices are drafts — **nothing reaches a client until you send it**.

The Invoices page

Summary cards up top show pending, awaiting-payment, and overdue totals. The tabs split invoices by status — **Pending, Sent, Paid, Overdue** — plus filters for Self-Directed and Group Home clients, and the purple **Scholarship** tab.

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Invoices

Manage and track all invoices

Pending Review

\$12,440.00

115 invoices

Awaiting Payment

\$45.00

1 invoice

All Invoices

116 invoices total. Select rows to send or update in bulk

Newest first

Pending (115)

Sent (1)

Paid (0)

All (116)

Self-Directed (27)

Group Home (54)

Scholarship (6 unbilled)

☐	Client	Service	Date	Payment Method	Amount	Status	Actions
☐	Maeve	Monthly Statement	Feb 2026	Scholarship	\$120.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	NTLC	Monthly Statement	Feb 2026	Scholarship	\$260.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	OLV	Music Expressions Group	Feb 9, 2026	Group Home	\$150.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	People Inc Day Hab	Music Expressions Group	Feb 26, 2026	Group Home	\$585.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	Kemet (Sarah Mulhollen)	Musical Expressions	Feb 26, 2026	Group Home	\$60.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	Kemet (Sarah Mulhollen)	Musical Expressions	Feb 12, 2026	Group Home	\$60.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	Kemet (Sarah Mulhollen)	Musical Expressions	Feb 11, 2026	Group Home	\$60.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	Harold (Robyn Woodhouse)	Musical Expressions	Feb 2, 2026	Private Pay	\$60.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	Harold (Robyn Woodhouse)	Musical Expressions	Feb 23, 2026	Private Pay	\$60.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	Harold (Robyn Woodhouse)	Musical Expressions	Feb 16, 2026	Private Pay	\$60.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	Harold (Robyn Woodhouse)	Musical Expressions	Feb 12, 2026	Private Pay	\$60.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	Elijah (Courtney Siever)	Adaptive Lesson	Feb 25, 2026	Private Pay	\$45.00	Pending	Send ...
☐	Elijah (Courtney Siever)	Adaptive Lesson	Feb 11, 2026	Private Pay	\$45.00	Pending	Send ...

Help

Sending an invoice

Open the ... menu on any invoice:

- **Send via Email** — generates a PDF and emails it to the client.
- **Send via Square** — creates a Square invoice with an online payment link. When the client pays online, the invoice marks itself **Paid** automatically. This is the lowest-effort path for clients who pay by card.

For invoices handled outside the app (checks, Venmo), use the quick **Send** and **Paid** buttons to record the status yourself. Checkboxes + the action bar let you **Mark Sent** / **Mark Paid** in bulk.

The screenshot displays the MCA Manager web application. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: Dashboard, Sessions, Clients, Billing (selected), Payroll, Analytics, Team, and Settings. The main content area shows the 'Invoice for NTLC' page. At the top, there's a header with 'Developer', 'May Creative Arts', and 'View As' buttons. Below this, the invoice title 'Invoice for NTLC' is followed by 'Monthly Statement - February 2026 (4 sessions)' and a 'Pending' status tag. A 'Client Preview' section shows a thumbnail of the invoice. The main preview area displays the invoice details for 'May Creative Arts Music Therapy Services'. It includes a 'MONTHLY STATEMENT' for February 2026 with invoice number INV-CA017036. The 'BILL TO' section lists 'NTLC'. The 'INVOICE DETAILS' section shows the date (July 4, 2026), due date (August 3, 2026), payment type (Scholarship), and status (PENDING). A table lists four sessions of 'Scholarship Group' therapy, each for \$65.00. The total due is \$260.00.

Service	Date	Amount
Scholarship Group Therapist: Colleen Milholland Duration: 30 minutes	Feb 3	\$65.00
Scholarship Group Therapist: Colleen Milholland Duration: 30 minutes	Feb 3	\$65.00
Scholarship Group Therapist: Colleen Milholland Duration: 30 minutes	Feb 10	\$65.00
Scholarship Group Therapist: Colleen Milholland Duration: 30 minutes	Feb 10	\$65.00

4 sessions

Total Due: \$260.00

Reminders are automatic. Unpaid sent invoices get email reminders before their due date (by default 7 days and 1 day before, each sent once). You don't chase these by hand.

The Scholarship tab — once a month

Scholarship and monthly-billed clients don't get per-session invoices. Their sessions pile up here, grouped by client and month. At month end, click **Generate Invoice** on a group — or **Generate All** — and the app creates one batch invoice per client listing every session as a line item. Batches are created as Pending, so you review before sending like any other invoice.

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Invoices

Manage and track all invoices

Pending Review

\$12,440.00

115 invoices

Awaiting Payment

\$45.00

1 invoice

All Invoices

116 invoices total. Select rows to send or update in bulk

Newest first

Pending (115)

Sent (1)

Paid (0)

All (116)

Self-Directed (27)

Group Home (54)

Scholarship (6 unbilled)

Scholarship and monthly-billed clients are invoiced once per month. Generate a batch invoice for each client per month.

Generate All (4)

Unbilled Sessions

Bentley

June 2026

1 session

Generate Invoice

Service	Date	Contractor	Duration
Musical Expressions	Jun 9	Amara May	30 min

Bentley

February 2026

1 session

Generate Invoice

Service	Date	Contractor	Duration
Scholarship Individual Session	Feb 3	Colleen Milholland	30 min

Devon

February 2026

2 sessions

Generate Invoice

Help

7. Team

See the whole team, and bring new people on board.

The Team page lists every member with their role and session counts. As an admin you can view the team and **invite new members**: click **Invite Team Member**, pick the role (Contractor or Admin), and either email the invite or copy a link to share directly. They set up their own account from the link — the same flow you went through on day one.

Changing roles, pay rates, and removing members is handled by the owner.

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Team Management

Manage contractors and view their performance

Invite Team Member

Total Team Members

11

1 admin, 7 contractors

Total Sessions

127

All time

Pending Contractor Pay

\$7,016.00

Awaiting payment

Active Contractors

7

Currently active

Team Members

All users with access to the system

Overview

Rates

Name	Contact	Role	Sessions	Total Earned	Pending Pay	Actions
Amara May maycreativearts@gmail.com	maycreativearts@gmail.com 716.432.0044	owner	1	\$0.00	-	...
Brianna Nilsen briannanilsen@gmail.com	briannanilsen@gmail.com 716.912.0563	contractor	0	\$0.00	-	...
Caroline West carolinewestmt@gmail.com	carolinewestmt@gmail.com 716.390.0453	contractor	0	\$0.00	-	...
Chelsea Flatley chelseafatley@gmail.com	chelseafatley@gmail.com	owner	0	\$0.00	-	...
Colleen Milholland cmilholland17@gmail.com	cmilholland17@gmail.com 716.343.5864	admin	50	\$3,713.00	\$3,713.00	...
Jacob Nicholson jacob@soundtransformationsmt.com	jacob@soundtransformationsmt.com 315.297.0524	contractor	27	\$1,425.50	\$1,425.50	...
Katie Stuermer creativeremedies23@gmail.com	creativeremedies23@gmail.com 716.550.6336	contractor	0	\$0.00	-	...
Lucas Weber weberlucasdev@gmail.com	weberlucasdev@gmail.com 716.572.1357	developer	1	\$45.00	\$45.00	...
Maddie Gilbert madelinegilbert027@gmail.com	madelinegilbert027@gmail.com 716.983.4795	contractor	0	\$0.00	-	...
Megan Brunner megan.brunner250@gmail.com	megan.brunner250@gmail.com 631.508.1437	contractor	17	\$585.00	\$585.00	...
Miley Heisler miley.heislermt@gmail.com	miley.heislermt@gmail.com 618.975.4354	contractor	31	\$1,247.50	\$1,247.50	...

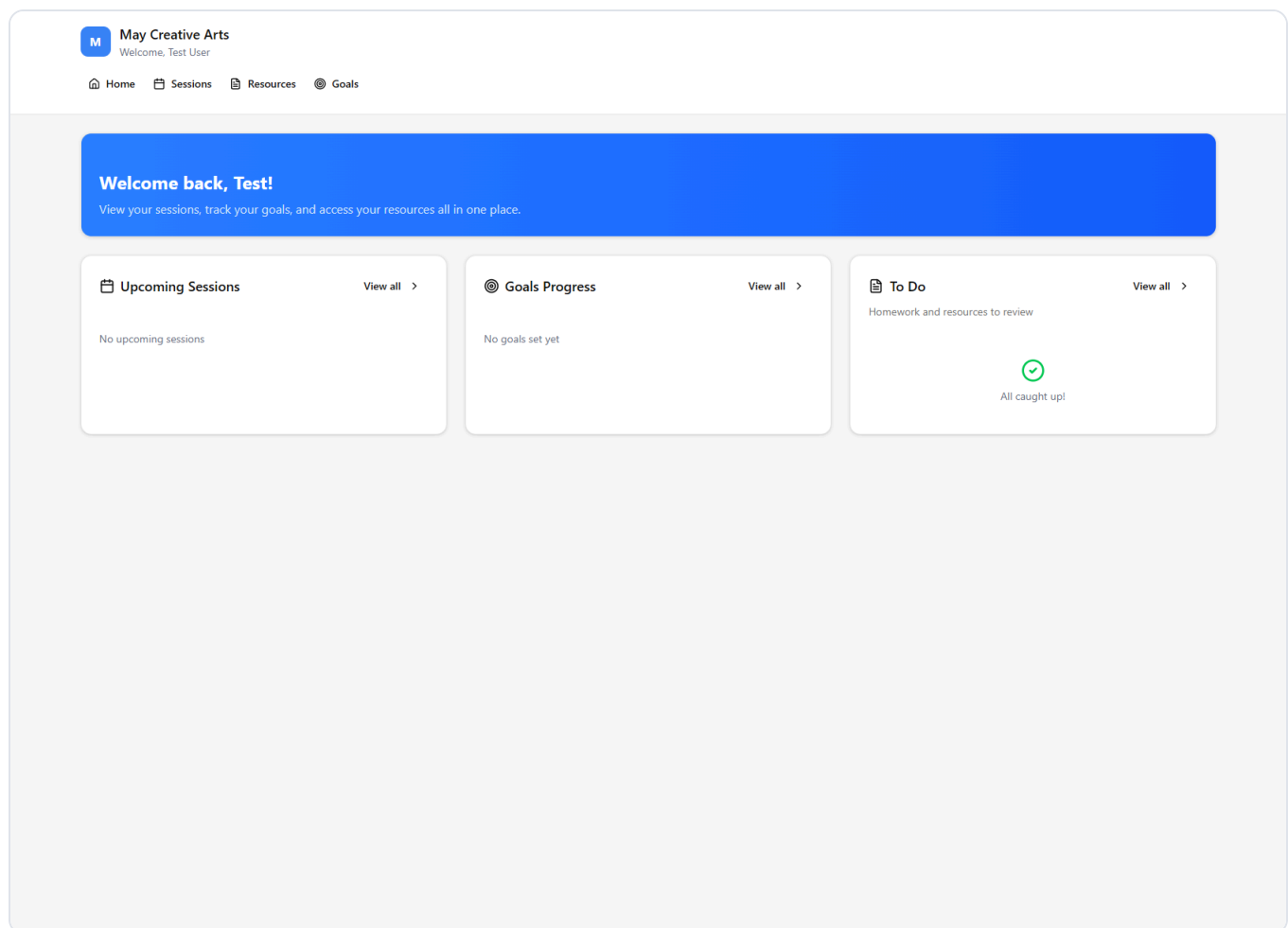
Help

8. The Client Portal

What clients see when you send them a portal invite.

The portal is a simplified, secure view for clients and families — no account or password needed, just the tokenized link from their invite. They can see their session history with any **Client Notes** you or contractors shared, their goals and progress, and resources (files) shared with them. If enabled, they can also request a session, which comes to staff for approval.

Portal links expire after a while (90 days by default) — if a client says their link stopped working, just send a fresh invite from their client page.



Remember the notes rule: anything typed into **Client Notes** is visible in the portal. Anything for staff eyes only belongs in **Internal Notes**.

9. Learn More & Getting Help

The Help Center is built into the app — articles, FAQs, walkthroughs, and an AI helper.

Interactive walkthroughs — take them in this order

#	WALKTHROUGH	WHEN
1	App Overview	Day one — your orientation tour.
2	Approve Sessions	Before your first review — the core of your job.
3	Log a Session	First week — so you can help contractors and fill gaps.
4	Add Your First Client	Before you add a real client.
5	Scholarship Billing	Before your first month-end batch.
6	Invite a Contractor	Whenever someone new joins.

Find them all in **Help** — each one highlights the actual buttons on the actual screens. (You may also see service-type configuration walkthroughs; those cover owner-managed settings.)

The screenshot displays the MCA Manager Help Center. At the top, the header includes 'MCA Manager', a user profile 'Developer', and a dropdown menu 'May Creative Arts'. Below the header, a left sidebar lists navigation options: Dashboard, Sessions, Clients, Billing, Analytics, Team, and Settings. The main content area is titled 'Help Center' and contains a search bar, a filter bar with tabs for 'All', 'Getting Started' (3 articles), 'Clients' (3), 'Sessions' (3), 'Invoices' (3), 'Team' (2), 'Analytics' (4), and 'Settings' (6). The main area features a grid of topic cards: 'Getting Started' (Learn the basics of using the app, 3 articles), 'Clients' (Managing your client list and portal, 3 articles), 'Sessions' (Logging and tracking sessions, 3 articles), 'Invoices' (Billing, invoicing, and payments, 3 articles), 'Team' (Managing your team and contractor rates, 2 articles), and 'Analytics' (Reports, analytics, and payroll, 4 articles). Below the grid is a 'Settings' card (Configuration and preferences, 6 articles). At the bottom, a 'Popular Articles' section highlights 'Getting Started with MCA Manager' (An overview of the app and how to navigate its main features) and 'Adding a Client' (How to add a new client and configure their billing settings), both with 'Walkthrough' buttons.

When you're stuck

- **Search the Help Center** — articles cover every page and workflow in the app.
- **Ask the AI helper** (sparkle button, bottom-right) — plain-English questions about how things work, including *your* organization's actual rates and settings. It cannot see client, session, or invoice data — so keep client names out of your questions, and check the relevant screen directly for "why does this specific invoice look wrong" questions.
- **Ask Lucas or Amara** — for anything owner-level: pricing changes, new service types, automation, payroll.

Small comfort feature: the sun/moon icon in the header switches light/dark mode.

10. What's Owner-Only

Things you'll hear about but won't see in your menus — by design, not by accident.

AREA	WHAT IT IS
Payroll	Tracking and recording contractor payments.
Analytics	Revenue charts, session volume, payment status summaries.
Organization settings	Service types & pricing, automation rules, branding, custom lists, business rules.
Financial breakdowns	The internal split of each session's price (MCA share vs. contractor pay). You see billing totals; the split is owner-level.
Team management	Changing roles and pay rates, removing members (you <i>can</i> view the team and send invites).

If a task needs one of these, flag it to the owner — don't work around it.

11. Quick Reference

Print this page.

Your rhythm

CADENCE	WHAT TO DO
Daily	Open the Dashboard → work the Action Center. Review and approve submitted sessions.
Weekly	Invoices page → send anything sitting in Pending; glance at Overdue and follow up.
Monthly	Invoices → Scholarship tab → Generate All → review the batches → send.

How do I...?

TASK	WHERE
Approve a session	Sessions → Approve on the card (or checkboxes → bulk approve)
Send a session back for fixes	Sessions → Revise → add a note
Record a no-show	Open the session → Mark No-Show
Log a session for someone	Sessions → New Session
Add a client	Clients → Add Client (set payment + billing method carefully)
Send an invoice	Invoices → ... menu → Send via Email / Send via Square
Record a check/Venmo payment	Invoices → Paid button on the invoice
Run monthly scholarship billing	Invoices → Scholarship tab → Generate All
Give a client portal access	Clients → open client → send portal invite
Invite a new team member	Team → Invite Team Member
Change my password / 2FA	Settings → Profile & Security
Answer "how does X work?"	Help Center, or the AI helper (no client names!)

